

MODULE 2 - CONVENTIONS

The Conventions - Cheat Sheet

The seven files that turn a folder into a brain, with the 4-Place Rule.

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The Conventions - Cheat Sheet

Five conventions turn a folder of markdown into a real brain. This is the printable summary. Keep it on your desk for the first month. After that you will not need it.

File	Purpose	Format	Append-only?
CLAUDE.md	Master context. The first thing every agent reads.	Sections: repo map, current state, code rules, commit conventions, behavior rules.	No - edited as state changes.
AGENTS.md	Cross-agent rules. Who does what. When to hand off.	Roles, behavior rules, runtime layer.	No - edited as the agent stack changes.
MEMORY.md	Standing facts that persist across sessions.	YYYY-MM-DD - headline, then 2-5 sentences.	Yes. Newer entries above older entries.
Daily_Log.md	Append-only timeline of what happened.	YYYY-MM-DD - one-line headline, then 2-3 paragraphs.	Yes.
Decision_Log.md	Decisions with rationale and alternatives considered.	Numbered. Title, context, decision, alternatives, rationale, decided by, references.	Yes. Numbered sequentially forever.
Change_Log.md	Commit-style ledger. Every SHA, grouped by date.	Date heading, bulleted SHAs with one-line headlines and sub-bullets.	Yes.
Feature_Inventory.md	Status of every feature: full / partial / planned.	Table: feature, status, last-verified SHA, date, source-of-truth path.	Rows updated; never deleted. Deprecated rows stay with status "deprecated".

The 4-Place Rule

Every meaningful change lands in **four** of these files - not one or two. Daily Log, Change Log, Decision Log (if it is a decision), Feature Inventory (if it changes feature status). Major beats also get a paragraph in a per-project Build Journey doc when one exists.

The rule exists because the moment a change is logged in only one place, three months later you cannot reconstruct what happened. Four places is redundant on purpose.

Memory file conventions

- Append-only. Never edit an old entry.
- New entries at the top.

- Date in YYYY-MM-DD format. ISO sorts cleanly.
- Headline is one short, declarative line.
- Body is 2-5 sentences. If you need more, write a doc and link from a one-line memory.
- Supersession is explicit - never silent. Write a new entry above that says "Supersedes the YYYY-MM-DD entry."

What goes where - quick decisions

You want to record...	Goes in...
What you did today	Daily_Log.md
A decision with alternatives	Decision_Log.md
A code change with a SHA	Change_Log.md
A feature shipped or moved status	Feature_Inventory.md
A standing fact about you or the business	memory-types/user.md
A correction you keep making to an agent	memory-types/feedback.md
A scope decision on a project	memory-types/project.md
An external doc agents should cite	memory-types/reference.md
A cross-cutting fact that doesn't fit elsewhere	MEMORY.md
A handoff to a new session	sessions/Session_<date>_<topic>.md